Equifax

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Organization & Cybersecurity Vision

A business-led cybersecurity strategy for Equifax

Who we are?

We are Equifax, we power global economic decisions through vital credit reporting, data analytics, and verification services.

What are we trying to protect?

We are protecting the integrity of consumer information, sustaining essential decision services, and limiting the business impact of cyber incidents.

What are our greatest risks?

Significant risks include third-party partner compromise, decision-service disruptions, AI-agent misuse, and data manipulation.

What should we do about it?

We recommend a 36-month roadmap prioritizing Zero Trust architecture, predictive automation, and robust third-party oversight.

Critical Business Functions

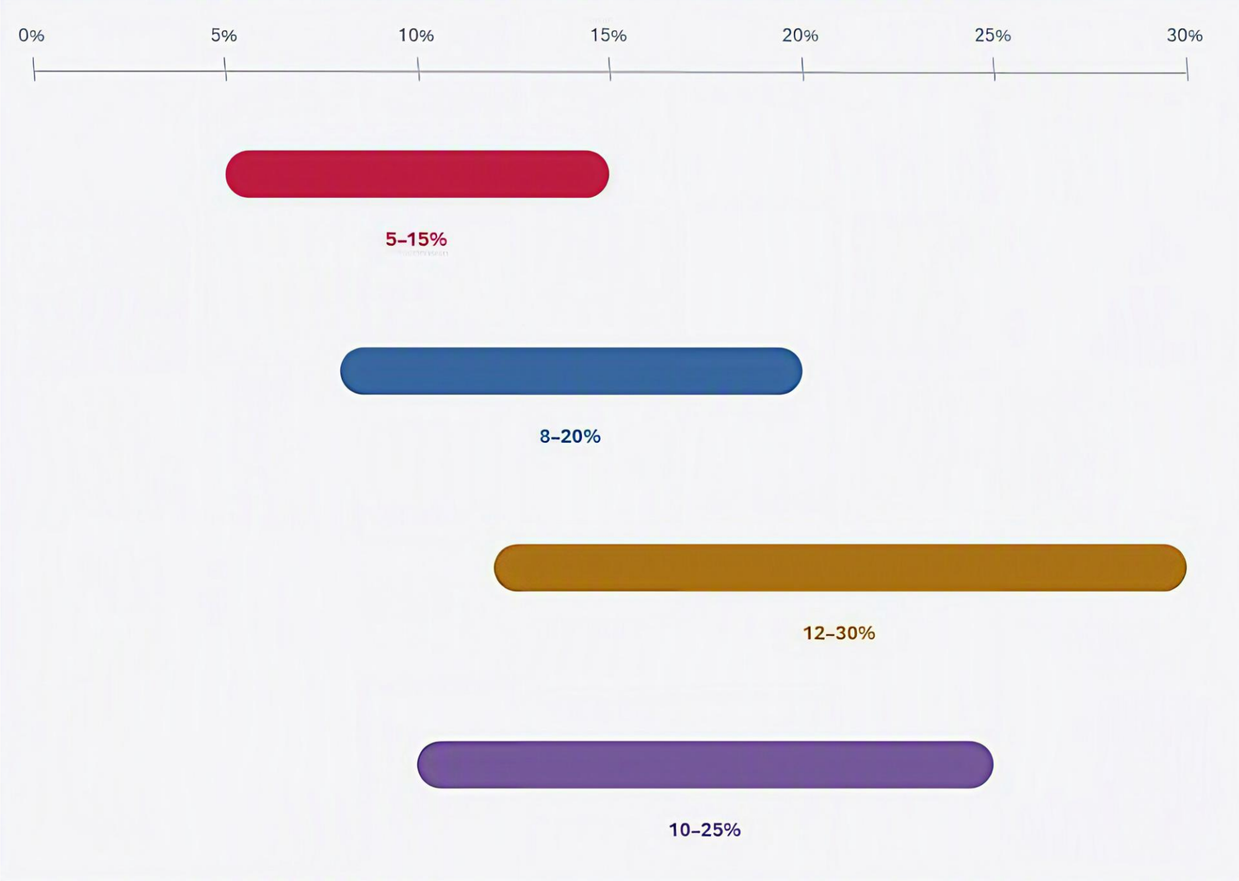
Business Functions	Critical Business Functions	Implicit trust exposure
• Credit Reporting: Timely profiles and dispute resolution. • Identity Verification: Confirming employment, income, and identity. • Decision APIs: 24/7 automated underwriting and approvals. • Enterprise Services: Reliable data pipelines for clients.	• Credit & PII Data: Highly confidential financial and personal records. • Data Fabric Integrity: Analytics pipelines resistant to tampering. • Decision Service Uptime: Cloud APIs enabling instant transactions. • Privileged Access: Root keys, IAM roles, and admin consoles.	• Service Accounts: Persistent permissions without session limits. • Admin Privileges: Excessive continuous access. • Third-Party Access: 2,280+ vendors and partners. • Machine Identities: Automated workloads with minimal oversight

Cyber Risk Landscape

Four Main Risks

12-month Team Forecasts

1. Sensitive Data Compromise
2. Critical Service Disruption
3. Third-party Partner Compromise
4. AI / Machine Identity Misuse



How We Forecast:
Outside-in evidence → Equifax factors → Planning range

Reasoning Behind These Forecast Ranges

1 DATA COMPROMISE | 5–15%

Outside-in:	Vulnerability exploitation remains a common breach path.
Raises:	Equifex holds large amounts of valuable sensitive data.
Lowers:	Strong maturity, fest detection and cloud controls.
Why:	Possible, but controls lower the chance of a major incident. Assumes controls keep working.

2 SERVICE DISRUPTION | 8–20%

Outside-in:	Ransomware and disruptive attacks remain common.
Raises:	Always-on services rely on cloud, data feeds and vendors.
Lowers:	Cloud resilience and regular cyber exercises.
Why:	Outages can happen without data theft. Assumes recovery tests reflect real incidents.

3 THIRD-PARTY COMPROMISE | 12–30%

Outside-in:	Attackers inoreasingly use trusted vendors as entry points.
Raises:	2,280+ vendor reviews show a large dependenoy surface.
Lowers:	Equifex has an active third-party risk program.
Why:	Highest/widest range because Equifax controls partners less directly. Assumes key dependencies are known.

4 AI / MACHINE-IDENTITY MISUSE | 10–25%

Outside-in:	AI and machine identities can act quickly and at soale.
Raises:	AI use and non-human identities are growing.
Lowers:	Guardrails, automated checks and human oversight.
Why:	Wider range because the risk is newer and less predictable. Assumes governance keeps pace.

Third-party risk is widest because Equifax has less direct control; service disruption can happen even without a data breach.

Sources: Verizon 2026 DBIR; Equifax 2025 Annual Report & Security Annual Report; MIT 5970 Risk Forecasting.

Strategic Priority 1: Zero Trust & Identity

- **Risk: 5-15%** (data compromise)

•Audit privileged access and over-permissioned service accounts
•Deploy Privileged Access Management (PAM) to replace permanent admin rights
•Implement continuous access validation and microsegmentation

- **Goal:** 90% of critical privileged access is time-limited and approved.

Strategic Priority 2: Operational Resilience

- Mitigate **8-20% risk** of service disruption
- Deploy immutable, air-gapped backups and failover testing
- Map critical dependencies to eliminate single points of failure
- Conduct recovery exercises with business owners

Goal: 90% of recovery exercises meet approved targets

Strategic Priority 3:
Third-Party Risk

- **Risk: 12-30%** (partner compromise, our highest)

- Rank partners by data access, dependency, and impact
- Time-limited, least-privilege access plus contract controls
- Joint incident response plans for tier-1 partners

- **Goal:** 100% of critical partners assessed, scoped, and owned

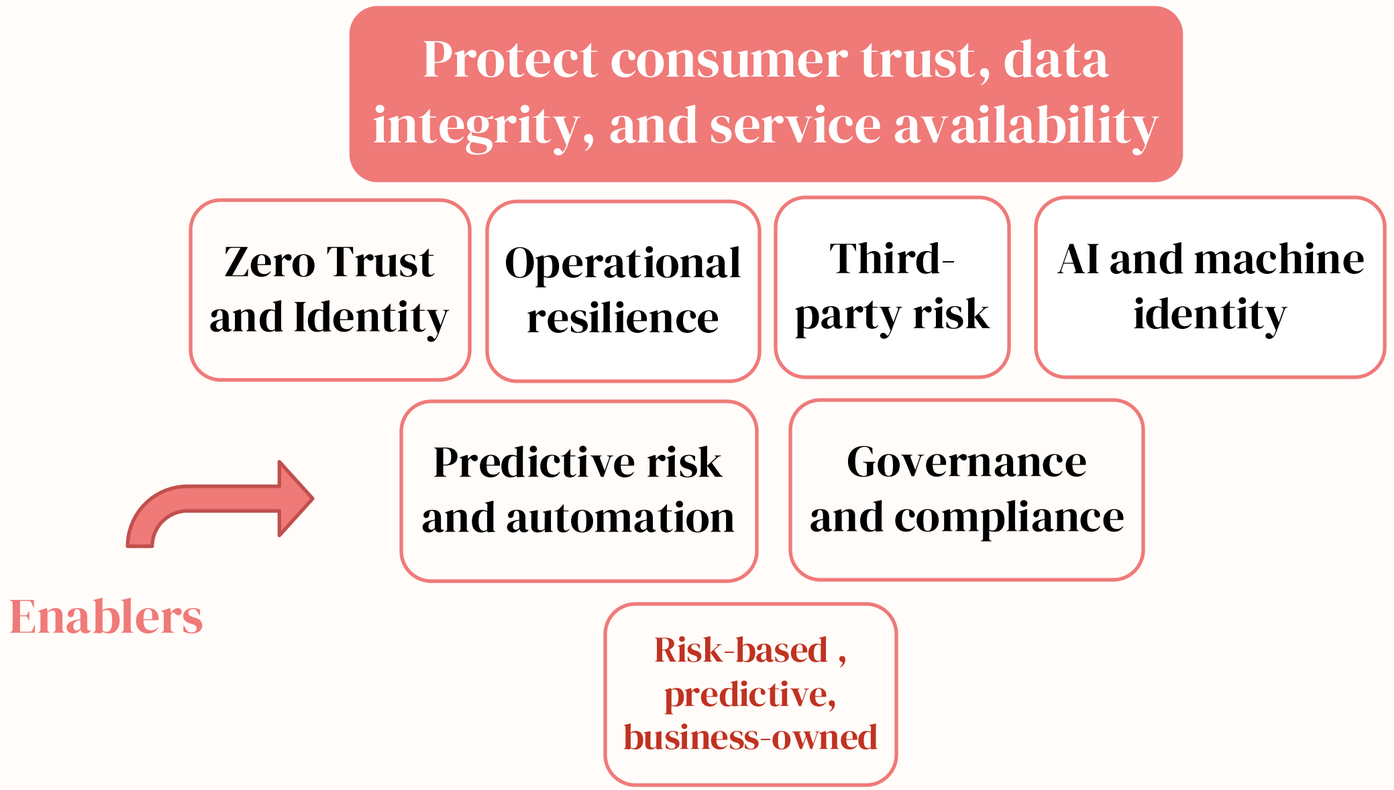
Strategic Priority 4: AI & Machine Identities

- **Risk: 10-25%** (AI/machine-identity misuse)

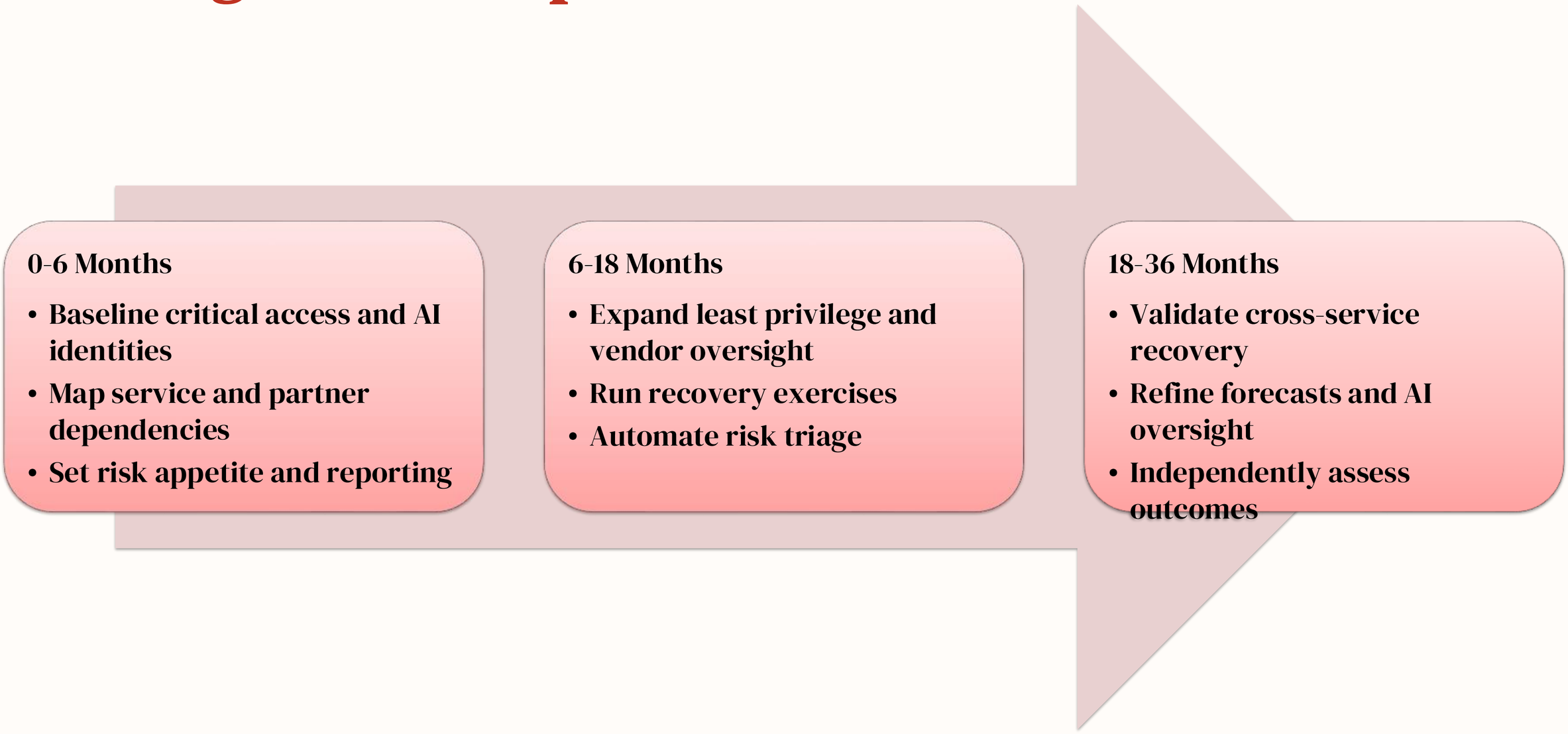
- Central inventory with a business owner for each
- Least privilege and human sign-off on high-impact outputs
- Continuous monitoring for behavioral drift

- **Goal:** 100% of high-risk workflows have owners, verified permissions, and monitoring

How It Fits


Protect consumer trust, data integrity, and service availability
Zero Trust and Identity
Operational resilience
Third-party risk
AI and machine identity
Predictive risk and automation
Governance and compliance
Enablers
Risk-based , predictive, business-owned

Strategic Roadmap



Sequencing principle: address high-impact access and dependencies first; scale only after baselines and owners are established

Executive Recommendation

Endorse Priorities	Approve the four strategic outcomes and phased 36-month sequences
Assign Accountability	Name executive sponsors and business owners for critical services and partners
Fund the First Phase	Authorize baselines, critical access governance, dependency mapping, recovery planning
Require Evidence	Review risk forecasts, exceptions, recovery results, and outcomes each quarter